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United States Patent	12401676
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Systems and methods for performing an external vulnerability scan using external internet protocol addresses

Abstract

System and methods for external vulnerability scanning a network are described. When a user equipment is attached to a network, the network provides information about the user equipment to a lookup table. In some examples, the lookup table is maintained by a network, such as mobile network, that facilitates packet-based communications between the user equipment to devices on the Internet. A scanner that performs the external vulnerability scan is provided information stored in the lookup table. The scanner returns the results of the scan to the mobile network.

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Appl. No.:	18/468584
Filed:	September 15, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250097250 A1	Mar. 20, 2025

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04L9/40 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04L63/1433 (20130101); H04L63/1425 (20130101); H04L63/20 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04L (63/1433); H04L (63/1425); H04L (63/20)

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) When supporting various types of networks, such as enterprise networks, it may be beneficial to scan the network for potential security issues. There are various types of security scans including, but not limited to, internal scans, port scans, external scans, network security scans, and environmental scans. Specific scans may include virus/malware scans, network port scans, penetration tests, rogue access point scans, program bug scans, vulnerability scans, and user permission-level scans. Network administrators and organizations often perform one or more of these scans periodically to identify and reduce the probability of vulnerabilities in a network. These vulnerabilities may be exploited by unknown entities (e.g., hackers) to retrieve sensitive proprietary data or to introduce software into the network that can be used for illicit purposes.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The detailed description is described with reference to the accompanying figures. In the figures, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the figure in which the reference number first appears. The same reference numbers in different figures indicate similar or identical items.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an illustrative wireless communication network environment in which systems and techniques for scanning user equipment are implemented, in accordance with

examples of the disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a flow diagram of an illustrative process for updating a lookup table, in accordance with examples of the disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram of an illustrative process for scanning a user equipment, in accordance with examples of the disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of illustrative components in an example user device that is configured for scanning a user equipment, in accordance with examples of the disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of illustrative components in an example computing device that is configured for scanning a user equipment, in accordance with examples of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(7) Overview

(8) This disclosure is directed in part to systems and techniques for security scanning a network using a lookup table. A lookup table is used by a scanner to perform a targeted, external scan of one or more devices of a network, such as a local area network (LAN), wide area network (WAN), a virtual private network (VPN), and the like. An external scan of a network tests vulnerabilities of a network by accessing the network infrastructure and components from a communication node outside of the network, e.g., beyond a network's firewall, router, or other device acting as an access to the network. In conventional systems, these types of scans are often done in a random or semi-random nature, whereby a scanner probes a network using randomly generated internet protocol (IP) addresses, attempting to find a device to probe.

(9) When the number of available IP addresses is relatively small, such as 32-bit address used for IP version 4 (IPv4) devices, often the scanner can randomly generate IP addresses to probe for IPV4 devices to perform a security scan. However, as technology has advanced, some devices have IP addresses that are significantly longer, such as IPv6 devices. IPV6 is a communication protocol that uses an address space of 128 bits. Scanning for IPV6 devices using a random number generator (or other technology to generate IP addresses to probe) can be problematic and place a significant strain on computing resources. For example, because of the longer length of address spaces, the probability that the scanner will generate a number that corresponds to an IPV6 device is significantly less than the probability that the scanner will generate a number that corresponds to an IPV4 device. This means that the scanner will have to perform a greater number of probes to find IPV6 devices, resulting in increased taxing of resources and use of communication bandwidth, as well as, potentially overwhelming a network firewall. Further, in the same manner, the chances of finding a device with a long address space is significantly lower, meaning that security scans can become less effective and fail to find potential security vulnerabilities.

(10) Various examples of the presently disclosed subject matter use a lookup table to provide a scanner with IP addresses of devices to probe. When a device is brought online by a router serving the network, a router or other device in the network provides the IP address of the device brought onto the network to network that implements the scanning operation, such as mobile cellular network. The IP address and other information about the device brought online may be obtained using various protocols, such as a neighbor discovery protocol (NDP). The main function of a NDP is the resolution of IPV6 addresses into valid MAC addresses, the respective devices' underlying hardware address. In IPV4, this function takes the Address Resolution Protocol (ARP). All determined addresses are stored as information in the neighbor cache. This buffer not only informs network users about the local addresses of the neighboring clients, but also supplies them with additional information required for the availability check. When performing a probe, the scanner is provided access to the lookup table and probes the network using the IP addresses provided in the lookup table.

(11) The scanner may probe based on various triggers (prompts). For example, the network implementing the scanning operation may notify the scanner that a new device, such as an IPV6 device, has been brought onto a network and provide the IP address to probe. The scanner may then

use that information to probe for the device. In another example, the scanner may periodically probe the lookup table for new devices not previously probed. The scanner downloads those IP addresses, probes the devices, and then updates the lookup table to indicate that the one or more devices not previously probed have now been probed. In other examples, the scanner may access the lookup table and find devices that have not been probed for a certain period of time. After probing, the scanner may then update the lookup table. These and other examples are considered to be within the scope of the presently disclosed subject matter.

(12) Illustrative environments, signal flows, and techniques for implementing systems and methods are described below. However, the described systems and techniques may be implemented in other environments.

(13) Illustrative System Architecture

(14) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an illustrative wireless network environment **100** in which the disclosed systems and techniques may be implemented, in accordance with examples of the disclosure. The environment **100** may include an enterprise network **102** and a mobile network **104**. The enterprise network **102** may be a network having one or more wired or wireless devices using the resources of the enterprise network **102**. The mobile network **104** may include various types of networks that support the communication between one or more devices using cellular network systems. The mobile network **104** may be one or more mobile telecommunication networks that facilitate communications between devices of various types, such as computing device and mobile devices (e.g., UEs). Various connections between devices in the mobile network **104** may be wired, wireless, or a combination thereof. The mobile network **104** may facilitate packet-based communications between devices in the enterprise network **102** and device on the Internet and/or one or more IMSs, such as IP multimedia system or subsystem (IMS) **108**.

(15) The mobile network **104** may include networks that support one or more 3GPP standards, including, but not limited to, Long Term Evolution (LTE) networks (e.g., 4G LTE networks) and New Radio (NR) networks (e.g., 5G NR networks). However, the disclosed systems and techniques may be applicable in any network or system in which a user device may request and receive access to communicate with network and/or remote devices using any protocol. A device in the enterprise network **102** may access the IMS **108** using protocols such as IPv4 and IPV6. A request for an IPV4v6 communications connection from the device (also known as a “dual stack” connection) may indicate that the device supports both IPV4 and IPV6. Such a device may prefer to use IPV6 but is able to use IPV4 in the event that an IPv6 connection is not available.

(16) Communication between the enterprise network **102** and the mobile network **104** may be provided through the use of one or more base stations, represented in FIG. 1 by gNodeB **106**. While referred to as a “gNodeB” for explanatory purpose herein, the gNodeB **106** may be any type of base station, including, but not limited to, any type of base transceiver station (BTS), NodeB, eNodeB, gNodeB, and the like. The gNodeB **106** may communicate with other devices and elements in the core of the mobile network **104**. The gNodeB **106** communicates with a router **110** in the enterprise network **102** to provide communicates to and from the IMS **108** for devices accessing the IMS **108**.

(17) The enterprise network **102** includes user equipment (UE) **112A-112N** (hereinafter referred to generically as “the UE **112**,” and individually as “the UE **112A**,” “the UE **112B**,” and “the UE **112N**”). The UE **112** are devices that are configured to communicate wirelessly or through a wired connection to the router **110** using various communication protocols. For example, the UE **112A** is a wired connection that has been brought onto the enterprise network **102** by the router **110** and assigned an IP address space for IPV4 communications. The UE **112B** is a wired connection that has been brought onto the enterprise network **102** by the router **110** and assigned an IP address space for IPV6 communications. The UE **112N** is a wireless connection that has been brought onto the enterprise network **102** by the router **110** and assigned an IP address space for IPV6 communications. The UE **112** may be computers, servers, tablets, smartphones, mobile telephones,

and other computing devices capable of and configured to communicate with the router **110**.

(18) Once the UE **112** has been brought up onto the enterprise network **102** by the router **110**, the UE **112** can access services provided by the IMS **108** through the router **110** and the gNodeB **106** by establishing a protocol data unit (PDU) session at the mobile network **104**. A PDU session, for example in a 5G network, may be an end-to-end communications session between a device (e.g., the UE **112**) and a data network (e.g., the IMS **108**). The gNodeB **106** may relay or otherwise convey this PDU session request from the UE to an access management function (AMF) **114** in the core of the wireless network in which the gNodeB is configured. The AMF **114** may interact with one or more other components to perform the operations needed to establish this session, such as authenticating the device and/or user, registering the UE **112** with the mobile network **104**.

(19) The AMF **114**, based on receiving this request for the establishment of a PDU, i.e., an IPV4-type or IPV6-type session on behalf of the UE **112**, may query an NRF **116** for an address (e.g., IP address) for a session management function (SMF) **118** with which it may interact to establish the requested PDU session. The AMF **114** may exchange SMF discovery communications **120** (Namf-Nnrf), which may be called an SMF address request in some examples, with the NRF **116**. The NRF **116** returns the identifier of the SMF **118** for use by the AMF **114**. Thereafter, the AMF **114** sends a connection request N11 to the selected SMF **118**. In examples, the SMF **118** may provide the access information needed by the UE **112** to communicate with a data network using the established session. The SMF **118** provides this information to the AMF **114** for relay to the gNodeB and ultimately to the UE **112** requesting the PDU session. In 5G examples, a message that provides such information may be referred to as a “NIN2MessageTransfer.” These and other messages communicating similar information may be referred to generally herein as a “message transfer” messages. The SMF **118** further establishes a connection to its coordinating user plane function (UPF) **122** through an N4 interface, which facilitates communications between the UE **112** and the IMS **108**. The SMF **118** instantiates a connection N3 from the gNodeB **106** to the UPF **122** to provide a communication path between the UE **112**, through the router **110**, and from the gNodeB **106**, to and from the IMS **108** through either the IPV6 or the IPV4&IPV6 lane.

(20) When one of the UEs **112** connect to the router **110**, the router **110** assigns the UE **112** an IP address to which the UE **112** sends and receives data to and from the IMS **108**. If the UE **112** is a device that uses the IPV4 protocol, the UE **112** is assigned an IP address in an address space associated with IPV4 communication protocols. If the UE **112** is a device that uses the IPV6 protocol, the UE **112** is assigned an IP address in an address space associated with IPV6 communication protocols. When the UE **112**, such as the UE **112B**, is assigned an address space associated with IPV6 communication protocols, the address space assigned is provided to a lookup table **124** of the mobile network **104**.

(21) The lookup table **124** is a data store used to store, among other data, address spaces (including external IP addresses) assigned by one or more enterprise networks **102** to the user equipment in the enterprise networks **102**. The lookup table **124** may also store other data such as, but not limited to, a geographic region of the UE **112B**, a geographic region of the enterprise network **102**, a date/time when the UE **112B** was assigned an IP address, a media access control (MAC) address, and the like. The lookup table **124** can further be updated by the router **110** when the UE **112B** is assigned an IP address (brought onto the enterprise network **102**). In some examples, as part of the operations of the router **110**, when a UE such as the UE **112B** is brought onto the enterprise network **102**, the router **110** can perform a neighbor discovery protocol (NDP) operation. In some examples, in the case the IPV4 UEs, the router **110** can perform the address resolution protocol (ARP). The presently disclosed subject matter is not limited to any particular protocol. The data created by the router **110** can be used to update the lookup table **124**.

(22) The lookup table **124** is used by a scanner **126** to attempt to detect one or more security vulnerabilities in the enterprise network **102**. Some types of security vulnerabilities include, but are not limited to, misconfiguration of a UE, outdated or unpatched software, unauthorized access,

unsecured application programming interfaces (APIs), zero-day vulnerabilities, stolen or weak user credentials, and the like. The scanner **126** may be implemented or controlled by the mobile network **104** or may be a third-party service provided to and used by the mobile network **104**. The presently disclosed subject matter is not limited to any particular configuration.

(23) The scanner **126** is triggered when a security scan is desired. The trigger in response may vary, but may include, when a device is brought onto the enterprise network **102**, a period of time has elapsed since the last scanning operation, an input by the mobile network **104** requesting a security scan, a prompt by a security monitor **130**, and the like. When the scanner **126** is triggered, the scanner **126** accesses the lookup table **124** through an application programming interface (API) **128**. In some examples, the scanner **126** may have stored in a memory of the scanner **126** the lookup table **124** or may be able to access the lookup table **124** without the need for the use of the API **128**. Thus, the presently disclosed subject matter is not limited to the use of the API **128**, as the scanner **126** may have access to the data in the lookup table **124** using other means or technology.

(24) The scanner **126** retrieves data for a scan from the lookup table **124** and uses that data to perform an external vulnerability scan on the enterprise network **102**. In some examples, an external vulnerability scan involves scanning external IP addresses and domains to probe for vulnerabilities in Internet-facing infrastructure to determine possible exploits. In some other examples, the external vulnerability scans a target IP address to scan for perimeter defenses such as websites, web applications, and network firewalls. As noted above, rather than randomly selecting potential IPV6 address spaces used by the UEs **112** in the enterprise network **102**, the scanner **126** uses the IP address for the UE **112B** provided by, or stored in, the lookup table **124**. In some examples, the scanner **126** may perform various types of external security scans depending on the particular configuration of the scanner **126**. The scan information generated by the scanner **126** is provided to the security monitor **130**. The security monitor **130** may be implemented by the mobile network **104** or may be a service provided by a third-party. The security monitor **130** may provide the scan information to the mobile network **104**, the enterprise network **102**, or another entity depending on the particular configuration of the security monitor.

(25) Illustrative Operations

(26) FIG. 2 shows a flow diagram of an illustrative process **200** for updating the lookup table **124**, in accordance with examples of the disclosure. The process **200**, including the process **300** described below, is illustrated as a collection of blocks in a logical flow diagram, which represents a sequence of operations that can be implemented in software and executed in hardware. In the context of software, the blocks represent computer-executable instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, perform the recited operations. Generally, computer-executable instructions include routines, programs, objects, components, data structures, and the like that perform functions and/or implement particular abstract data types. The order in which the operations are described is not intended to be construed as a limitation, and any number of the described blocks can be omitted and/or combined in any order and/or in parallel to implement the processes. For discussion purposes, the process **200** may be described with reference to the wireless network environment **100** of FIG. 1, however other environments may also be used. Further, although the processes **200** and **300** may be described in terms of IPV6 devices, the presently disclosed subject matter may be used with other types of communication protocols, including, but not limited to, IPV4.

(27) At block **202**, an IPV6 device, such as the UE **112N** of FIG. 1, commences communicating with the enterprise network **102**. The UE **112N** may commence communicating using various means, such as connecting to Wi-Fi provided by the enterprise network **102**, physically connecting an ethernet cable, such as a CAT6 cable, to an ethernet port connected to the enterprise network **102**, and the like.

(28) At block **204**, the router **110** commences NDP to bring the UE **112N** onto the network. It should be noted that other technologies for bringing the UE **112N** onto the enterprise network **102**

may be used, such as address resolution protocol and Internet control message protocol, and are considered to be within the scope of the presently disclosed subject matter. Generally, the NDP includes the processes of router advertisement, router solicitation, neighbor solicitation, neighbor advertisement, and redirects. In some examples, the IP address in the MAC address is resolved using the NDP.

(29) At block **206**, the results of the NDP are provided to the lookup table **124** of the mobile network **104**. As noted above, the lookup table **124** may store the IP address of the UE **112N**, the time the NDP process was completed for the UE **112N**, neighbor IP addresses of the UE **112N**, and the like. The lookup table **124** may also store the last time the UE **112N** was scanned if the UE **112N** was previously attached to the enterprise network **102**, and other information. The information in the lookup table **124** is used by the scanner **126** to scan one or more components of the enterprise network **102** to search for security vulnerabilities, described in FIG. 3, below.

(30) FIG. 3 shows a flow diagram of an illustrative process **300** for scanning a user equipment, in accordance with examples of the disclosure.

(31) The process **300** commences at block **302**, where the mobile network **104** prompts the scanner **126** to perform a security scan on the UE **112N**. In this example, the prompt is generated when the lookup table **124** is updated by the router **110** when the UE **112N** is attached to the enterprise network **102**. However, as noted above, the mobile network **104** may prompt the scanner **126** for other reasons such as a period of time has elapsed between scans. The presently disclosed subject matter is not limited to any particular reason that the scanner **126** is prompted. Further, the prompt may be generated from other sources, such the router **110** providing a notice to the scanner **126** that the router **110** has attached the UE **112N** to the enterprise network **102**.

(32) At block **304**, information stored in the lookup table **124** is provided to the scanner **126**. The information may include the external IP address of the one or more UEs to be scanned, such as the UE **112N**. It should be noted that the scanner **126** may not be prompted each time a UE, such as the UE **112N** of the present example, is attached to the enterprise network **102**. For example, the scanner **126** may be prompted at a certain time of the day to scan UEs attached to the enterprise network **102** in the prior twenty four hour period (batch processing), may be prompted to scan after a certain number of UEs have been attached, and/or may be prompted to scan after a certain period of time (such as every two hours). These and other techniques may be used to reduce bandwidth or perform scans during times in which the enterprise network **102** may not be used to a high degree, such as a time period during which workers that may use the enterprise network **102** may not be working.

(33) At block **306**, the mobile network **104** may receive the results of the security scan from the scanner **126**. The results may include the UEs scanned, any vulnerabilities detected, the time of the scan, and the like.

(34) At block **308**, the mobile network **104** may notify one or more entities, such as the enterprise network **102**, of the results of the scan. These results may be used by the enterprise network **102** to maintain the security of the enterprise network **102**.

Example User Equipment

(35) FIG. 4 is an example of a scanner, such as the scanner **126**, for use with the systems and methods disclosed herein, in accordance with some examples of the present disclosure. The scanner **126** may include one or more processors **402**, one or more transmit/receive antennas (e.g., transceivers or transceiver antennas) **404**, and a data storage **406**. The data storage **406** may include a computer readable media **408** in the form of memory and/or cache. This computer-readable media may include a non-transitory computer-readable media. The processor(s) **402** may be configured to execute instructions, which can be stored in the computer readable media **408** and/or in other computer readable media accessible to the processor(s) **402**. In some configurations, the processor(s) **402** is a Central Processing Unit (CPU), a Graphics Processing Unit (GPU), or both CPU and GPU, or any other sort of processing unit. The transceiver antenna(s) **404** can exchange

signals with a base station, such as gNodeB **106**.

(36) The scanner **126** may be configured with a memory **410**. The memory **410** may be used to store data received from the lookup table **124**. The memory **410** may be implemented within, or separate from, the data storage **406** and/or the computer readable media **408**. The memory **410** may include any available physical media accessible by a computing device to implement the instructions stored thereon. For example, the memory **410** may include, but is not limited to, RAM, ROM, EEPROM, a SIM card, flash memory or other memory technology, CD-ROM, DVD or other optical disk storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which may be used to store the desired information, and which may be accessed by the scanner **126**.

(37) The memory **410** can store several modules, such as instructions, data stores, and so forth that are configured to execute on the processor(s) **402**. In configurations, the memory **410** may also store one or more applications **414** configured to receive and/or provide voice, data and messages (e.g., SMS messages, Multi-Media Message Service (MMS) messages, Instant Messaging (IM) messages, Enhanced Message Service (EMS) messages, etc.) to and/or from another device or component (e.g., the gNodeB **106**). The applications **414** may further include applications to retrieve data from the lookup table **124** as well as provide scanning data to the mobile network **104**. The applications **414** may also include one or more operating systems and/or one or more third-party applications that provide additional functionality to the scanner **126**.

(38) Although not all illustrated in FIG. **4**, the scanner **126** may also comprise various other components, e.g., a battery, a charging unit, one or more network interfaces **416**, an audio interface, a display **418**, a keypad or keyboard, and one or more input devices **420**, and one or more output devices **422**.

Example Computing Device

(39) FIG. **5** is an example of a computing device **500** for use with the systems and methods disclosed herein, in accordance with some examples of the present disclosure. The computing device **500** can be used to implement various components of a core network, a base station, and/or any servers, routers, gateways, gateway elements, administrative components, etc. that can be used by a communication provider. The computing device **500** can further be used to implement the security monitor **130** and/or the lookup table **124**.

(40) In various embodiments, the computing device **500** can include one or more processing units **502** and system memory **504**. Depending on the exact configuration and type of computing device, the system memory **504** can be volatile (such as RAM), nonvolatile (such as ROM, flash memory, etc.) or some combination of the two. The system memory **504** can include an operating system **506**, one or more program modules **508**, and can include program data **510**. The system memory **504** may be secure storage or at least a portion of the system memory **504** can include secure storage. The secure storage can prevent unauthorized access to data stored in the secure storage. For example, data stored in the secure storage can be encrypted or accessed via a security key and/or password. The program modules can include instructions to execute the lookup table **124** of FIG. **1**.

(41) The computing device **500** can also include additional data storage devices (removable and/or non-removable) such as, for example, magnetic disks, optical disks, or tape. Such additional storage is illustrated in FIG. **5** by storage **512**.

(42) Non-transitory computer storage media of the computing device **500** can include volatile and nonvolatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information, such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data. The system memory **504** and storage **512** are examples of computer readable storage media. Non-transitory computer readable storage media includes, but is not limited to, RAM, ROM, EEPROM, flash memory or other memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile discs (DVD) or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other

magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information, and which can be accessed by computing device **500**. Any such non-transitory computer readable storage media can be part of the computing device **500**.

(43) In various embodiment, any or all of the system memory **504** and storage **512** can store programming instructions which, when executed, implement some or all of the functionality described above as being implemented by one or more systems configured in the environment **100** and/or components of the mobile network **104**.

(44) The computing device **500** can also have one or more input devices **514** such as a keyboard, a mouse, a touch-sensitive display, voice input device, etc. The computing device **500** can also have one or more output devices **516** such as a display, speakers, a printer, etc. can also be included. The computing device **500** can also contain one or more communication connections **518** that allow the device to communicate with other computing devices using wired and/or wireless communications. Example Clauses

(45) The following paragraphs describe various examples. Any of the examples in this section may be used with any other of the examples in this section and/or any of the other examples or embodiments described herein.

(46) A: All methods, systems, and apparatuses, including all equivalents, disclosed.

(47) Clause 1. A method, comprising: receiving, at a first network, an Internet protocol (IP) address of a user equipment attached to a second network; updating a lookup table, wherein the lookup table comprises the IP address of the user equipment; prompting a scanner to perform a scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment; providing the scanner with the IP address of the user equipment from the lookup table; and receiving results of the scanning operation.

(48) Clause 2. The method of clause 1, wherein the IP address of the user equipment is provided by a router servicing the second network.

(49) Clause 3. The method of any of clauses 1-2, wherein the router servicing the second network performs a neighbor discovery protocol to provide the IP address of the user equipment.

(50) Clause 4. The method of any of clauses 1-3, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to the first network receiving an update to the lookup table from the second network indicating that the user equipment has been attached to the second network.

(51) Clause 5. The method of any of clauses 1-4, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to a period of time elapsing between a prior scanning operation and the scanning operation.

(52) Clause 6. The method of any of clauses 1-5, wherein the IP address is associated with an address space for IPV6 communication protocols.

(53) Clause 7. The method of any of clauses 1-6, further comprising providing the results of the scanning operation to the second network.

(54) Clause 8. The method of any of clauses 1-7, wherein the scanning operation comprises scanning the IP address to probe for vulnerabilities to determine a possible exploit.

(55) Clause 9. The method of any of clauses 1-8, wherein the lookup table further comprises a geographic region of the user equipment, a geographic region of the second network, a date/time when the user equipment was assigned the IP address, and a media access control (MAC) address of the user equipment.

(56) Clause 10. A non-transitory computer-readable media storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations comprising: receiving, at a first network, an Internet protocol (IP) address of a user equipment attached to a second network; updating a lookup table, wherein the lookup table comprises the IP address of the user equipment; prompting a scanner to perform a scanning

operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment; providing the scanner with the IP address of the user equipment from the lookup table; and receiving results of the scanning operation.

(57) Clause 11. The non-transitory computer-readable media of clause 10, wherein the IP address of the user equipment is provided by a router servicing the second network.

(58) Clause 12. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-11, wherein the router servicing the second network performs a neighbor discovery protocol to provide the IP address of the user equipment.

(59) Clause 13. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-12, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to the first network receiving an update to the lookup table from the second network indicating that the user equipment has been attached to the second network.

(60) Clause 14. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-13, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to a period of time elapsing between a prior scanning operation and the scanning operation.

(61) Clause 15. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-14, wherein the IP address is associated with an address space for IPv6 communication protocols.

(62) Clause 16. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-15, further comprising providing the results of the scanning operation to the second network.

(63) Clause 17. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-16, wherein the scanning operation comprises scanning the IP address to probe for vulnerabilities to determine a possible exploit.

(64) Clause 18. The non-transitory computer-readable media of any of clauses 10-17, wherein the lookup table further comprises a geographic region of the user equipment, a geographic region of the second network, a date/time when the user equipment was assigned the IP address, and a media access control (MAC) address of the user equipment.

(65) Clause 19. A mobile telecommunications network, comprising: a lookup table configured to receive information about one or more user equipment attached to an enterprise network, the information comprising an external Internet protocol (IP) address for each of the one or more user equipment provided by the enterprise network when the one or more user equipment is attached to the enterprise network; a scanner configured to perform an external vulnerability scan of at least one of the one or more user equipment attached to the enterprise network, wherein the external vulnerability scan comprises scanning the at least one of the one or more user equipment using the IP address to determine possible exploits; and a security monitor configured to receive results of the external vulnerability scan and to provide the results to the enterprise network.

(66) Clause 20. The mobile telecommunications network of clause 19, wherein the information about the one or more user equipment attached to an enterprise network further comprises a geographic region of the one or more user equipment, a geographic region of the enterprise network, and a media access control (MAC) address of the one or more user equipment.

(67) While the example clauses described above are described with respect to one particular implementation, it should be understood that, in the context of this document, the content of the example clauses can also be implemented via a method, device, system, computer-readable medium, and/or another implementation. Additionally, any of the examples A-S can be implemented alone or in combination with any other one or more of the examples A-S.

Conclusion

(68) Depending on the embodiment, certain operations, acts, events, or functions of any of the algorithms described herein can be performed in a different sequence, can be added, merged, or left out altogether (e.g., not all described acts or events are necessary for the practice of the algorithm).

Moreover, in certain embodiments, acts or events can be performed concurrently, e.g., through multi-threaded processing, interrupt processing, or multiple processors or processor cores or on other parallel architectures, rather than sequentially.

(69) The various illustrative logical blocks, components, and algorithm steps described in connection with the embodiments disclosed herein can be implemented as electronic hardware, computer software, or combinations of both. To clearly illustrate this interchangeability of hardware and software, various illustrative components, blocks, modules, and steps have been described above generally in terms of their functionality. Whether such functionality is implemented as hardware or software depends upon the particular application and design constraints imposed on the overall system. The described functionality can be implemented in varying ways for each particular application, but such implementation decisions should not be interpreted as causing a departure from the scope of the disclosure.

(70) The various illustrative logical blocks, modules, and components described in connection with the embodiments disclosed herein can be implemented or performed by a machine, such as a general purpose processor, a digital signal processor (DSP), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field programmable gate array (FPGA) or other programmable logic device, discrete gate or transistor logic, discrete hardware components, or any combination thereof designed to perform the functions described herein. A general-purpose processor can be a microprocessor, but in the alternative, the processor can be a controller, microcontroller, or state machine, combinations of the same, or the like. A processor can also be implemented as a combination of computing devices, e.g., a combination of a DSP and a microprocessor, a plurality of microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in conjunction with a DSP core, or any other such configuration.

(71) The elements of a method, process, or algorithm described in connection with the embodiments disclosed herein can be embodied directly in hardware, in a software module executed by a processor, or in a combination of the two. A software module can reside in RAM memory, flash memory, ROM memory, EPROM memory, EEPROM memory, registers, hard disk, a removable disk, a CD-ROM, or any other form of computer-readable storage medium known in the art. An exemplary storage medium can be coupled to the processor such that the processor can read information from, and write information to, the storage medium. In the alternative, the storage medium can be integral to the processor. The processor and the storage medium can reside in an ASIC. The ASIC can reside in a user terminal. In the alternative, the processor and the storage medium can reside as discrete components in a user terminal.

(72) Conditional language used herein, such as, among others, “can,” “might,” “may,” “e.g.,” and the like, unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements, and/or states. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements, and/or states are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without author input or prompting, whether these features, elements and/or states are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment. The terms “comprising,” “including,” “having,” “involving,” and the like are synonymous and are used inclusively, in an open-ended fashion, and do not exclude additional elements, features, acts, operations, and so forth. Also, the term “or” is used in its inclusive sense (and not in its exclusive sense) so that when used, for example, to connect a list of elements, the term “or” means one, some, or all of the elements in the list.

(73) Unless otherwise explicitly stated, articles such as “a” or “the” should generally be interpreted to include one or more described items. Accordingly, phrases such as “a device configured to” are intended to include one or more recited devices. Such one or more recited devices can also be collectively configured to carry out the stated recitations. For example, “a processor configured to carry out recitations A, B and C” can include a first processor configured to carry out recitation A

working in conjunction with a second processor configured to carry out recitations B and C. (74) While the above detailed description has shown, described, and pointed out novel features as applied to various embodiments, it will be understood that various omissions, substitutions, and changes in the form and details of the devices or algorithms illustrated can be made without departing from the spirit of the disclosure. As will be recognized, certain embodiments of the inventions described herein can be embodied within a form that does not provide all of the features and benefits set forth herein, as some features can be used or practiced separately from others. The scope of certain inventions disclosed herein is indicated by the appended claims rather than by the foregoing description. All changes which come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are to be embraced within their scope.

(75) Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the specific features or acts described. Rather, the specific features and acts are disclosed as illustrative forms of implementing the claims.

Claims

1. A method, comprising: receiving, at a first network, an Internet protocol (IP) address of a user equipment attached to a second network; updating a lookup table, wherein the lookup table comprises the IP address of the user equipment, a geographic region of the user equipment, a geographic region of the second network, and a date/time when the user equipment was assigned the IP address; prompting a scanner to perform a scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment; providing the scanner with the IP address of the user equipment from the lookup table; and receiving results of the scanning operation.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the IP address of the user equipment is provided by a router servicing the second network.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the router servicing the second network performs a neighbor discovery protocol to provide the IP address of the user equipment.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to the first network receiving an update to the lookup table from the second network indicating that the user equipment has been attached to the second network.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to a period of time elapsing between a prior scanning operation and the scanning operation.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the IP address is associated with an address space for IPV6 communication protocols.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising providing the results of the scanning operation to the second network.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the scanning operation comprises scanning the IP address to probe for vulnerabilities to determine a possible exploit.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the lookup table further comprises a media access control (MAC) address of the user equipment.
10. A non-transitory computer-readable media storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations comprising: receiving, at a first network, an Internet protocol (IP) address of a user equipment attached to a second network; updating a lookup table, wherein the lookup table comprises the IP address of the user equipment, a geographic region of the user equipment, a geographic region of the second network, and a date/time when the user equipment was assigned the IP address; prompting a scanner to perform a scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of

the user equipment; providing the scanner with the IP address of the user equipment from the lookup table; and receiving results of the scanning operation.

11. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, wherein the IP address of the user equipment is provided by a router servicing the second network.

12. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 11, wherein the router servicing the second network performs a neighbor discovery protocol to provide the IP address of the user equipment.

13. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to the first network receiving an update to the lookup table from the second network indicating that the user equipment has been attached to the second network.

14. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, wherein prompting the scanner to perform the scanning operation on the second network using the IP address of the user equipment is done in response to a period of time elapsing between a prior scanning operation and the scanning operation.

15. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, wherein the IP address is associated with an address space for IPv6 communication protocols.

16. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, further comprising providing the results of the scanning operation to the second network.

17. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, wherein the scanning operation comprises scanning the IP address to probe for vulnerabilities to determine a possible exploit.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable media of claim 10, wherein the lookup table further comprises a media access control (MAC) address of the user equipment.

19. A mobile telecommunications network, comprising: a lookup table configured to receive information about one or more user equipment attached to an enterprise network, the information comprising an external Internet protocol (IP) address for each of the one or more user equipment provided by the enterprise network when the one or more user equipment is attached to the enterprise network, wherein the lookup table further comprises a geographic region of the one or more user equipment, a geographic region of the enterprise network, and a date/time when the one or more user equipment was assigned the IP address; a scanner configured to perform an external vulnerability scan of at least one of the one or more user equipment attached to the enterprise network, wherein the external vulnerability scan comprises scanning the at least one of the one or more user equipment using the IP address to determine possible exploits; and a security monitor configured to receive results of the external vulnerability scan and to provide the results to the enterprise network.

20. The mobile telecommunications network of claim 19, wherein the lookup table further comprises a media access control (MAC) address of the one or more user equipment.
